



Department of Computer Science
COMSATS University Islamabad

CSC417 - 10

E-Commerce & Digital Marketing

Submitted By:

Muhammad

Abdullah

FA24-BSE-042

LAB 8

Lab Task 1: Competitive Analysis – SharePath

1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive SEO competitive analysis for SharePath (live-share-path.pantheonsite.io), a WordPress-based ride-sharing platform developed for COMSATS University Islamabad students. Using SEMrush, the analysis identifies three primary competitors in the ride-sharing and mobility space within Pakistan, evaluates their SEO performance, and develops actionable recommendations to improve SharePath's organic visibility and search rankings.

SharePath is currently a prototype website with limited SEO authority. The competitive benchmarks below provide the roadmap to building a stronger digital presence.

2. SharePath Website Overview

Website Area	Implementation Details
Homepage	Hero section with ride-sharing value proposition, how-it-works section, and CTA for student sign-up.
Booking / Ride Matching	Route-based ride matching form connecting student drivers and passengers.
About / Safety	Platform trust signals including COMSATS student verification and safety policy.
Blog / Content	Educational content area for commute tips, safety guides, and campus updates.
Current SEO Position	New prototype; limited organic authority. SEMrush shows 0 organic keywords currently indexed.

3. Competitor Identification

Using SEMrush's Domain Overview tool on the SharePath domain, the following main organic competitors were identified in the Pakistani ride-sharing and mobility market:

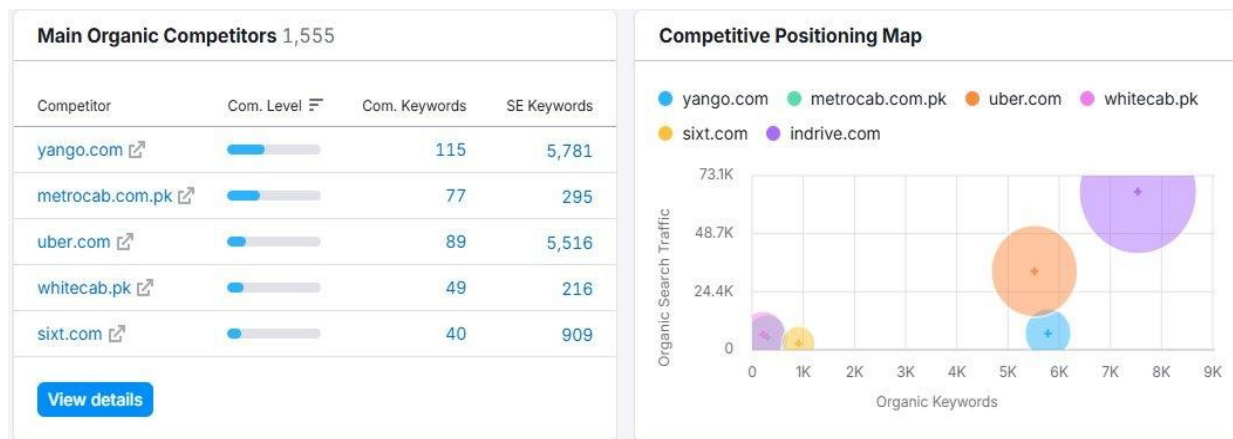


Figure 1: SEMrush Main Organic Competitors and Competitive Positioning Map for the SharePath domain.

Competitor	Type	Why Selected
yango.com	Direct	Ride-hailing service operating in Pakistan; competes for urban commute-related search queries.
metrocab.com.pk	Direct	Local Pakistani cab and ride service; strong local keyword overlap with student commute queries.
uber.com	Direct / Indirect	Global ride-hailing giant; dominant organic presence; competes for all ride-related keywords in PK.
whitecab.pk	Direct	Pakistani ride-sharing/taxi service targeting urban commuters.
indrive.com	Direct	Price-negotiation-based ride service popular in Pakistan; strong organic footprint.
sixt.com	Indirect	Car rental/sharing platform; indirect competition for mobility-related searches.

The three primary competitors selected for detailed analysis are: Yango, MetroCab, and Uber — as they represent the strongest direct competition for ride-sharing search intent in Pakistan.

4. Competitor Domain Metrics Comparison

4.1 Yango.com – Domain Overview



Figure 2: SEMrush Domain Overview for yango.com (Pakistan filter, May 2026).

Metric	Value	Interpretation for SharePath
Authority Score	52 (Very Good)	Strong domain authority — SharePath should target long-tail keywords Yango ignores.
Organic Traffic	7K (+9.3%)	Growing organic presence in PK market; ride-sharing content is gaining traction.
Organic Keywords	5,800 (+3.1%)	Thousands of indexed keywords — SharePath can target niche student commute terms.
Referring Domains	5.3K	Strong backlink profile from diverse sources.
Backlinks	249.8K	Extensive link-building history; SharePath needs a targeted backlink strategy.

Metric	Value	Interpretation for SharePath
AI Visibility	49	Strong presence in AI search results — SharePath should optimize for AI search intent.

4.2 MetroCab.com.pk – Domain Overview



Figure 3: SEMrush Domain Overview for metrocab.com.pk (Pakistan filter, May 2026).

Metric	Value	Interpretation for SharePath
Authority Score	27 (Good)	Moderate authority — more achievable benchmark for SharePath to compete against.
Organic Traffic	5.4K (-0.8%)	Slight decline — opportunity to capture its audience with fresher content.
Organic Keywords	295 (-6.1%)	Limited keyword footprint — SharePath can outrank it with targeted content.
Referring Domains	111	Small backlink profile — achievable to surpass with active link building.
Backlinks	57.2K	Moderate backlink base.
AI Visibility	19	Weak AI search visibility — opportunity for SharePath to dominate this channel.

4.3 Uber.com – Domain Overview

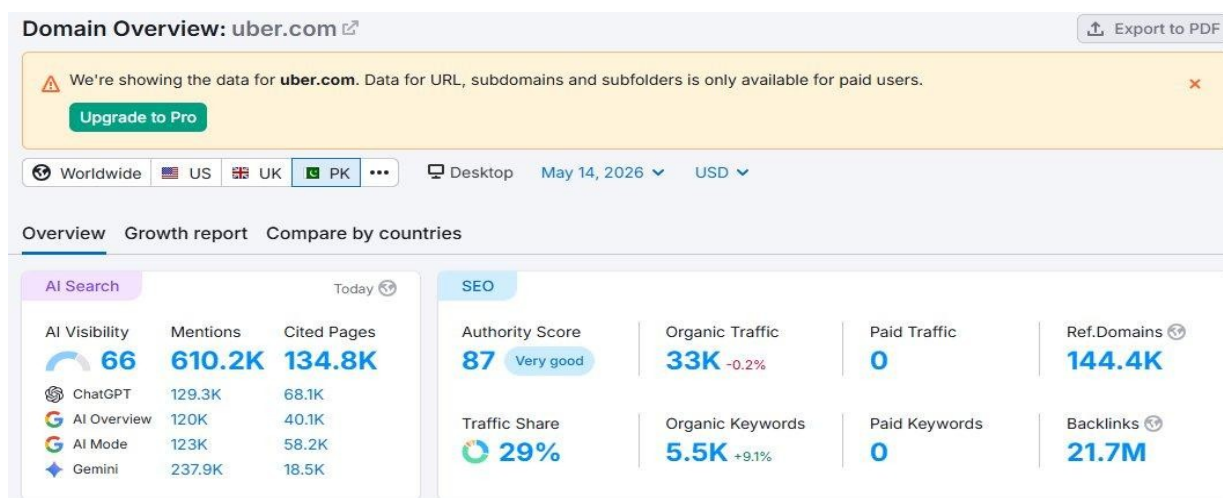


Figure 4: SEMrush Domain Overview for uber.com (Pakistan filter, May 2026).

Metric	Value	Interpretation for SharePath
Authority Score	87 (Very Good)	Dominant global authority — SharePath should not compete for Uber's core keywords.
Organic Traffic	33K (-0.2%)	Massive organic footprint — focus on niche keywords Uber doesn't target.
Organic Keywords	5,500 (+9.1%)	Growing keyword portfolio in Pakistan.
Referring Domains	144.4K	Enormous backlink profile — unreachable in short term.
Backlinks	21.7M	Global backlink authority at scale.
AI Visibility	66	Highest AI visibility — indicates strong brand recognition in AI platforms.

5. Keyword Gap Analysis

Using SEMrush's Keyword Gap tool, SharePath was compared against indrive.com to identify missing keyword opportunities. The results revealed significant high-volume keywords that SharePath currently has zero presence for:

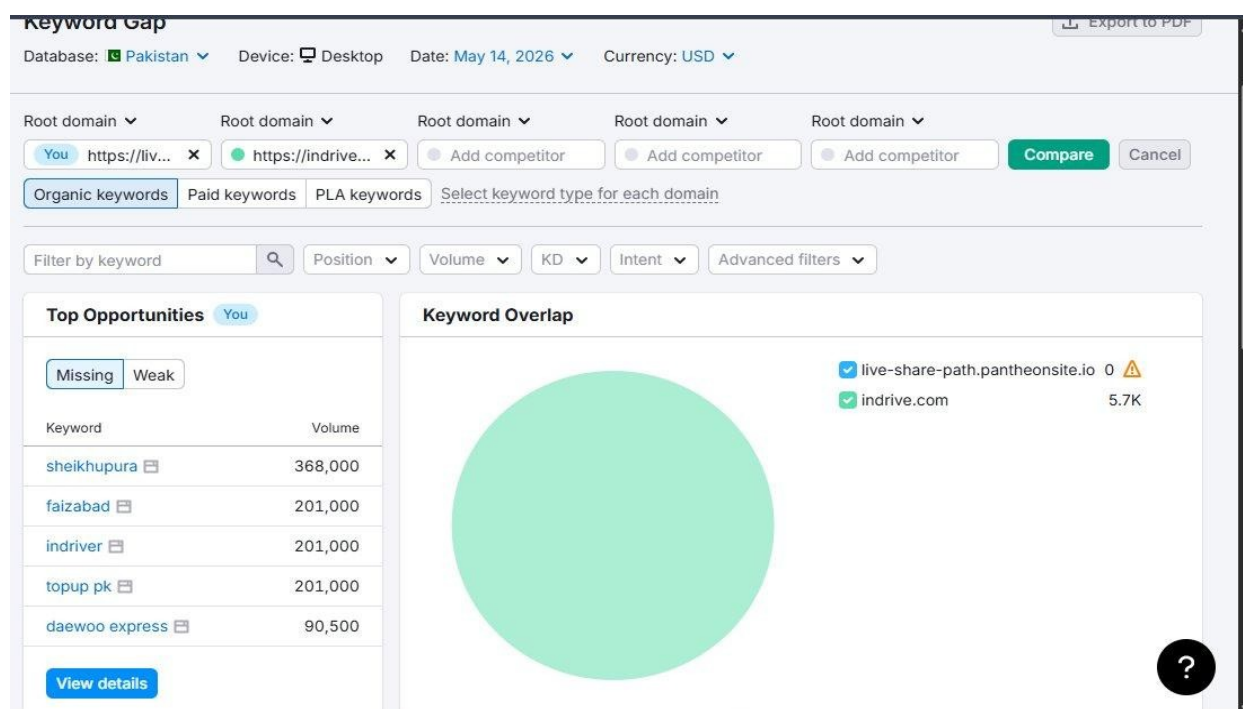


Figure 5: SEMrush Keyword Gap analysis — SharePath vs. InDrive.com showing top missing keyword opportunities.

Missing Keyword	Monthly Search Volume	Opportunity for SharePath
sheikhupura	368,000	High-volume geographic keyword — create location-based ride content.
faizabad	201,000	Key Rawalpindi commute hub — target students commuting from Faizabad.
indriver	201,000	Brand keyword of competitor — target with comparison content.
topup pk	201,000	Payment-related query — relevant for SharePath's student payment features.
daewoo express	90,500	Intercity bus service alternative — target students who use buses.

These keywords represent immediate opportunities where SharePath can create blog content, location pages, or service guides to begin capturing organic traffic.

6. Backlink Gap Analysis

SEMrush's Backlink Gap tool identified high-quality referring domains that competitors have backlinks from, but SharePath does not. These represent outreach targets for SharePath's link-building strategy:

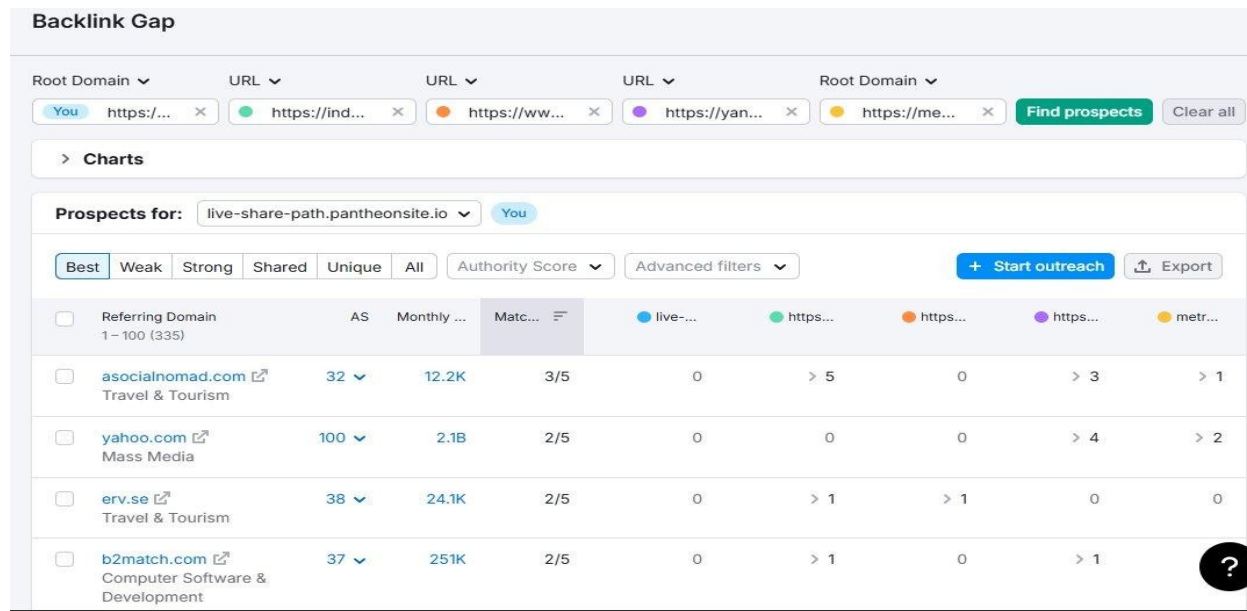


Figure 6: SEMrush Backlink Gap tool showing best prospect domains for SharePath link-building.

Referring Domain	Authority Score	Category	Strategy for SharePath
yahoo.com	100	Mass Media	Submit SharePath as a startup story or news pitch to Yahoo News Pakistan.
asocialnomad.com	32	Travel & Tourism	Guest post on commute/travel content mentioning SharePath.
erv.se	38	Travel & Tourism	Explore travel insurance/transport partnership content.
b2match.com	37	Computer Software	List SharePath at startup/tech matchmaking events.

7. On-Page SEO Analysis

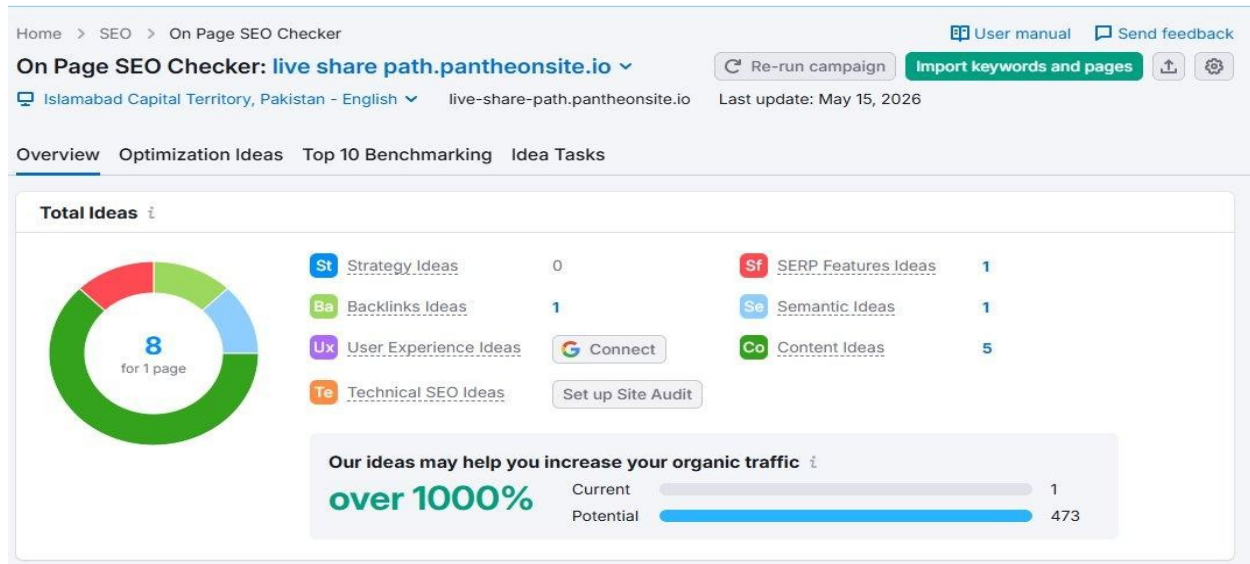


Figure 7: SEMrush On-Page SEO Checker for SharePath — 8 total optimization ideas identified.

The On-Page SEO Checker identified 8 optimization ideas across 1 analyzed page with potential to grow organic traffic by over 1000% (from 1 current visitor to 473+ potential). Key areas flagged:

- Content Ideas (5 issues): Thin content on key pages; needs expansion with ride-sharing guides and FAQs.
- Backlinks Ideas (1 issue): Insufficient inbound links to core landing pages.
- SERP Features Ideas (1 issue): Missing structured data markup (FAQ schema, local business schema).
- Semantic Ideas (1 issue): Keyword clustering and LSI terms not fully utilized in page content.

8. Site Audit Results

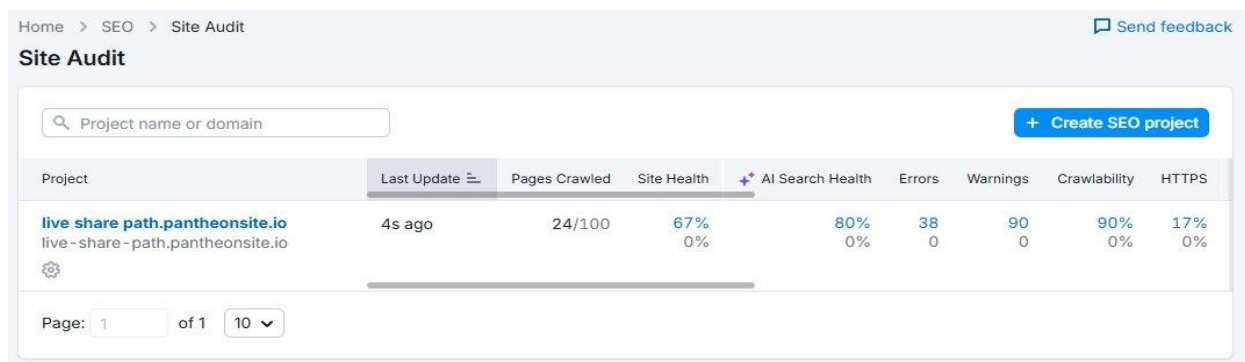


Figure 8: SEMrush Site Audit for SharePath — Site Health 67%, 38 errors, 90 warnings.

The Site Audit reveals significant technical SEO issues that must be addressed before content and backlink strategies can be effective:

Metric	Value	Priority Action
Site Health Score	67%	Needs improvement — target 85%+ by resolving errors and warnings.
Errors	38	Critical issues (broken links, missing tags) — fix immediately.
Warnings	90	Medium-priority issues (slow load times, missing alt text) — address within 2 weeks.
Crawlability	90%	Good — most pages are accessible to search engine crawlers.
HTTPS	17%	Critical — majority of pages not served over HTTPS; fix SSL configuration immediately.
AI Search Health	80%	Good AI search health — maintain structured content for AI visibility.

9. Position Tracking

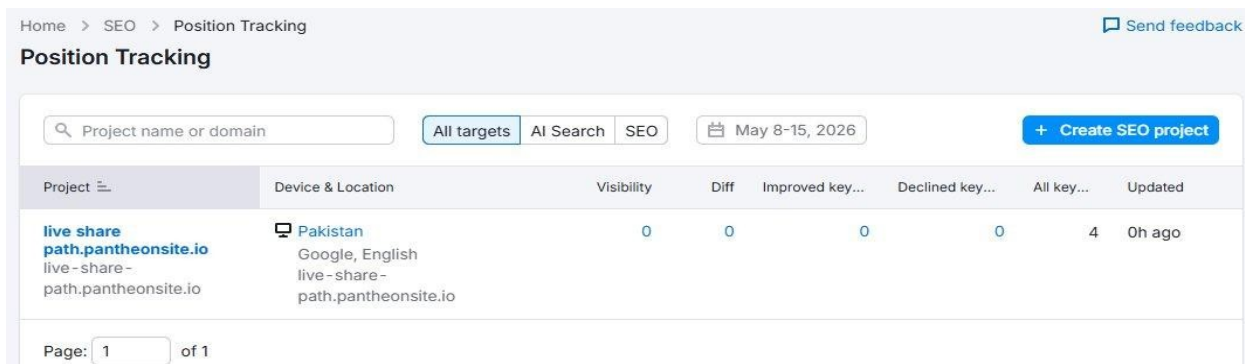


Figure 9: SEMrush Position Tracking dashboard for SharePath — tracking 4 keywords in Pakistan.

Position Tracking is currently set up for SharePath targeting Pakistan (Google, English). The dashboard shows 4 tracked keywords with 0 current visibility — confirming that the site has not yet ranked for any monitored keywords. This establishes the baseline from which progress will be measured after implementing the recommendations below.

Lab Task 2: The SEO Showdown – SharePath Competitive Strategy

1. Competitor Showdown Table

Criterion	Yango.com	MetroCab.com.pk	Uber.com	SharePath (Current)
Authority Score	52	27	87	New / 0
Organic Traffic (PK)	7K	5.4K	33K	~0
Organic Keywords	5,800	295	5,500	0
Referring Domains	5.3K	111	144.4K	0
HTTPS	Yes	Yes	Yes	17% (critical issue)
AI Visibility Score	49	19	66	0
Content Strategy	App downloads, city guides	Local cab booking	Global brand, city pages	Student ride-sharing (untapped)
Keyword Focus	Ride, taxi, city names	Cab, local routes	Uber + city combinations	None yet

2. Strengths and Weaknesses Summary

Yango.com

- Strengths: Strong authority score (52), growing organic traffic, good AI search visibility, international brand backing.
- Weaknesses: Not focused on student demographics; no campus-specific content; generic city pages.

MetroCab.com.pk

- Strengths: Local Pakistani brand; familiar to local users; lower authority score — more beatable.
- Weaknesses: Declining organic traffic (-0.8%), very limited keyword base (295), almost no AI visibility (19), weak backlink profile (111 domains).

Uber.com

- Strengths: Dominant global authority (87), massive backlinks, highest AI visibility (66), huge keyword portfolio.
- Weaknesses: Not targeting student-specific commuting niches; high-cost brand not aligned with student budgets; ignores carpooling content.

3. Opportunities for SharePath

Based on the competitor analysis, the following opportunities exist for SharePath to gain competitive advantage:

- **Student-Niche Keywords:** No competitor targets keywords like 'student carpool Islamabad', 'COMSATS ride sharing', or 'cheap university commute Pakistan' — SharePath can own this niche.
- **MetroCab's Declining Traffic:** MetroCab's -0.8% traffic decline and -6.1% keyword decline signals user dissatisfaction — SharePath can capture this audience with better content and UX.
- **Geographic Micro-Pages:** Create location-specific pages for Faizabad, Sheikhpura, and other high-volume commute hubs identified in the keyword gap analysis.
- **AI Search Optimization:** All three competitors have moderate-to-low AI visibility on Pakistani queries — SharePath can build strong AI search presence early by optimizing for conversational queries.
- **HTTPS Fix:** SharePath's 17% HTTPS rate is a critical weakness that, once fixed, will immediately improve trust signals and crawlability.

4. SharePath SEO Strategy

Phase	Timeline	Actions	KPI Target
Phase 1: Technical Fix	Week 1–2	Fix HTTPS (SSL) across all pages; resolve 38 Site Audit errors; submit sitemap to Google Search Console.	Site Health > 85%; HTTPS 100%
Phase 2: On-Page SEO	Week 3–4	Optimize title tags, meta descriptions, and headings on all core pages. Add FAQ schema and local business structured data.	On-Page score > 70/100
Phase 3: Content Creation	Month 2–3	Publish 8 blog articles targeting missing keywords: student carpool Islamabad, COMSATS ride, Faizabad commute, etc.	10+ indexed keywords
Phase 4: Link Building	Month 3–4	Outreach to yahoo.com news, travel blogs, and university websites for backlinks. Target 20 referring domains.	20+ referring domains
Phase 5: Monitor & Iterate	Ongoing	Use SEMrush Position Tracking to monitor keyword rankings. Publish 2 blog posts/month. Review analytics monthly.	40% traffic growth in 6 months

5. Expected Outcomes

By implementing the above strategy over 6 months, SharePath is expected to achieve the following outcomes:

- Increase Site Health from 67% to 85%+
- Index 50+ organic keywords within 3 months of content publishing
- Generate 500+ monthly organic visitors within 6 months
- Establish 20–30 high-quality backlinks from relevant domains
- Achieve AI search visibility score of 20+ within 4 months

6. Conclusion

SharePath operates in a competitive ride-sharing market dominated by global brands like Uber and regional players like Yango and MetroCab. However, none of these competitors specifically target the student commute niche — which represents SharePath's primary competitive advantage. By fixing critical technical SEO issues first, then building targeted content and backlinks around high-volume student commute keywords, SharePath can establish a strong organic presence in a space where its larger competitors are not focusing.

The SEMrush data confirms that even small local competitors like MetroCab are declining, creating a real window of opportunity. With consistent execution of the outlined strategy, SharePath can become the go